Kitchen Knife



Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 4 labs

Covers these lab items: Peeling knife; Serrated Bread Knife

What it is used for

To cut, slice, or peel food using a suitable kitchen knife. To prepare ingredients efficiently while maintaining food hygiene and preventing cuts.

Main parts

- Blade
- Handle
- Cutting edge
- Knife tip
- Protective storage or knife rack

Before you start

1. Choose a knife suitable for the food and cutting task.
2. Check that the blade is clean, sharp, and securely attached to the handle.
3. Use a stable cutting board and keep it from slipping.
4. Wash hands and clean the food as required.

How to use

1. Hold the knife by the handle with a secure grip.
2. Place the food firmly on the cutting board.
3. Use controlled slicing or peeling motions suited to the knife type.
4. Keep fingertips curled away from the cutting edge while guiding the food.
5. Use a serrated bread knife with a gentle sawing motion for bread.
6. Place the knife down safely when not in use.
7. Wash, dry, and store the knife after the task.

⚠ Safety

- Always cut away from the body where practical.
- Never try to catch a falling knife.
- Do not leave knives hidden in sinks or under food.
- Carry a knife with the point down and blade facing away from others.

Care & storage

- Wash and dry the knife after use.

- Sharpen and hone the blade using an appropriate method.
- Avoid using the knife on hard surfaces that can damage the edge.
- Store in a knife block, rack, or protective cover.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using a dull knife that requires excessive force.
- Cutting on an unstable board.
- Using a peeling knife for tasks beyond its design.
- Leaving a knife loose in a sink or drawer.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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